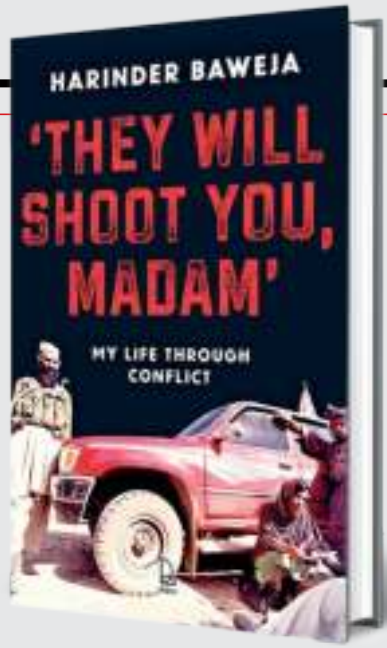
THEY WILL SHOOT YOU, MADAM: MY LIFE THROUGH CONFLICT
By Harinder Baweja
ROLI
₹895; 400 pages



BOOKS ▼

IN THE LINE OF FIRE

Harinder Baweja's *They Will Shoot You, Madam*, is an engaging account of reporting from conflict zones

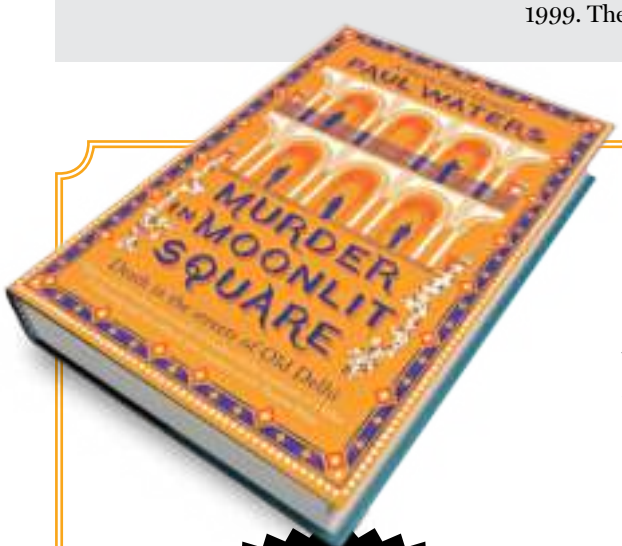
Harinder (Shammy) Baweja's status as a reporter is legendary. She has gone where few dare to venture and in this book she provides a powerful account of her reportage. The title itself is suggestive of the kind of areas she reported on—Pakistan, Punjab, Kashmir, Kargil and Afghanistan.

What marks out Baweja's reportage is not just raw courage, which some would say often verged on the foolhardy, but also its integrity. She does not hold back her punches and the interviews she did of a range of personalities are a testimony to that. All this is all the more remarkable because she is a woman reporter who worked in the conflict zone involving deeply misogynistic cultures.

The memoir charts her deeply personal journey from the then sleepy backwater of Chandigarh to the hotspots of India and its neighbourhood. So we are in blood-soaked Punjab in the 1980s where she had to eventually grapple with her Sikh identity following the Sikh massacres of 1984. We witness the turbulence in Jammu & Kashmir from the kidnapping of Rubaiya Sayeed, through the post-Babri Masjid turmoil, the Burhan Wani phenomenon and the revocation of Article 370. And we have a ringside view of the Kargil war of 1999. The book is full of striking encounters and visits, such as those to Pakistan, which featured two separate visits to the Muridke headquarters of the Lashkar-e-Taiba, as well as the so-called 'Azad Kashmir'. We also get notable portraits, like that of the gangster Chhota Rajan in Malaysia and Yasin Malik.

AN IMPORTANT ELEMENT OF HER **BOOK IS TO DOCUMENT THE INCREASING** EROSION OF INDIA'S SECULAR FABRIC

An important element of her book



MURDER IN MOONLIT SQUARE
By PAUL WATERS
BEDFORD SQUARE PUBLISHERS
₹550; 320 pages

BOOKS ▼

Capital Crime

PAUL WATERS' DEBUT CRIME NOVEL BLENDS IRISH WIT WITH OLD DELHI INTRIGUE

Paul", the author bio tells us, "fell in love with India when he fell in love with his wife. He's from Belfast. She's from Delhi." The real life love story gives this novel, the first of a new literary crime fiction series: 'A Haveli Hotel Mystery', a unique Indo-Irish inflection.

Sister Agatha Murphy bumps into Avtar Mehta, the owner of a hotel, in a back alley of Old Delhi, while they are both taking an "ad break", euphemism for a quick smoke. Within minutes, a wild sequence of events unfolds: they are witness to a street robbery involving an